

Perkins&Will

A \$795M firm of 2,600 people, growing 15% in two years — and **128 open roles of which two are in Canada**. That one number tells you what this relationship is and is not. Everything here is either billed work from our own ledger or checked against a named source.

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The read, in one page

THE FIRM

People · revenue	~2,600 · \$795.5M
Founded · headquarters	1935 · 410 N Michigan Ave, Chicago
Position	Second-largest architecture firm in the US
Headcount growth	+5.0% six months · +8.4% twelve · +14.8% twenty-four
Owner	Dar Al-Handasah (Shair and Partners)
Studios	32 by their own count

Open roles

128 — of which 2 are in Canada

► THE ONE INFERENCE WORTH CARRYING INTO THE ROOM

Their growth is American. Dallas alone has 18 open roles, San Francisco 14, Atlanta and Minneapolis 10 each. Vancouver has **one** and Calgary **one**. A firm hiring like that is not expanding in Canada — it is consolidating here and pushing hard in the US south and west.

So this is **not** a "grow with them into new markets" conversation. It is a conversation about **the Canadian work that already exists** — and the single most active Canadian thing they have going is mass timber housing, where a competitor already holds the structural seat. That is section 04, and it is the whole reason to talk to them tonight.

They also own **Portland Design** (UK), **Schmidt Hammer Lassen** (Denmark, 170 people), Penoyre & Prasad, lauckgroup, Sink Combs Dethlefs and Pfau Long — so the "five retail principals hired from an Amsterdam firm" in January were, in effect, an internal move: Portland Design is theirs.

THE RELATIONSHIP

What we have actually done together

Ten project records name Perkins&Will. **Seven were billed, \$536,544** — and four are 98% of it.

PROJECT	DEVELOPER	FEE	BILLED
River District Parcel 16.2	Wesgroup	\$235,000	\$236,125
600 Robson St	Bonnis Properties	\$140,000	\$120,460
900 Granville St	Bonnis Properties	\$92,500	\$91,770

PROJECT	DEVELOPER	FEE	BILLED
5696 Alberta St	Nicola Wealth	\$90,000	\$76,146
Harry Jerome Phase 1 — Bldg M4	Darwin Properties	\$97,000	\$9,840
357–475 West 41st Ave	Coromandel	\$142,000	\$1,700
Harry Jerome Phase 1 — signage	Darwin Properties	\$500	\$500

Lead with River District, 600 Robson and 900 Granville. Complete, substantial jobs where we carried structure and they carried design. Two Bonnis projects back to back says the pairing worked.

► HARRY JEROME IS A QUESTION, NOT A CREDENTIAL

Phases 2 and 3 for Darwin carry **\$430,000 of signed contract between them and have billed nothing** — no invoices, no time. Phase 1 billed \$9,840 against a \$97,000 fee.

So do **not** say "we did Harry Jerome". **Ask** what happened to it. It is the largest piece of unstarted work we hold with them, and either answer — stalled, or still ahead — is worth having.

✕ TWO THINGS NOT TO SAY

They have never been our paying client. All seven were invoiced to the *developer*. The one record under Perkins&Will's own account — ICBC Head Office — has no fee, no time, no invoice. Say "*we've worked alongside you*".

It has been a while. All opened 2018–19. Nothing since.

Where they are hiring, and what it means

A firm's open roles say more about next year than its press releases do. They have **128**.

WHERE	ROLES	WHAT	ROLES
Dallas	18	Workplace & corporate interiors	35
San Francisco	14	Healthcare	29
Atlanta · Minneapolis	10 each	Digital & computational	11
Seattle	9	Higher education & K-12	8
London	8	Urban design & landscape	5
Charlotte · Chicago	7 each	Science & labs	3
Houston	6	Sports, civic & transit	3
Vancouver · Calgary	1 each	Sustainability	1

- ♦ **Healthcare and corporate interiors are the engine** — 64 of the 128 between them. Their healthcare practice leader is **Jim Bynum**; workplace strategy sits with **Lisa Pool**.
- ♦ **They are standing up a transit practice.** Two of the postings are *Regional Practice Leader* — *Transit & Transportation Architecture*, one in Chicago and one in San Francisco. That is the same playbook as the retail build-out in January: hire the leadership first. They already have **Michal Mrowiec** as Transportation Practice Leader — and the Vancouver studio already lists **Jeff Doble** under transportation.
- ♦ **Only one sustainability role in 128.** For a firm that markets hard on carbon, the hiring is going elsewhere.

The mass timber opening — and who holds that seat

This is the reason to have the conversation.

In **February 2026** they published a study proposing a **prefabricated modular mass-timber system for Canadian housing**, backed by **\$250,000** from DIGITAL's Housing Growth Innovation programme.

× THE STRUCTURAL SEAT WENT TO A COMPETITOR

Named partners: **ASPECT Structural Engineers**, Introba, and SFU's School of Interactive Arts & Technology. A funded Canadian mass-timber housing programme with someone else in the structural chair.

It is not peripheral to them. When **Derek Newby was elevated to the RAIC College of Fellows on 27 May 2026**, the citation was for "*advancing lower-carbon construction, mass timber innovation, and climate leadership.*" He is quoted on the study — "*We can do much better. We can start today.*" — with Kathy Wardle. They are also designing **BCIT's zero-carbon tall timber student housing**, announced in January. Mass timber appears three separate times in the firm's own keyword profile.

The question to ask: who carries structure on the timber work, and whether that is settled. Two of the three people quoted are already our contacts. **Peter Busby** is the name most associated with tall wood in this city — he **founded the Canada Green Building Council** and holds the Order of Canada — but our records have him in a San Francisco role now, so the people who own this in Vancouver day to day are **Derek Newby** and **Kathy Wardle**. Both are on the next page. If Busby is in the room, the Green Building Council is the opening, not our project list.

PEOPLE

The Vancouver studio today

NAME	ROLE
Derek Newby	Managing Director — Vancouver and Calgary; Regional Managing Director, Canada
Peter Busby	Founded Busby + Associates (1984), which merged with Perkins+Will in 2004 and became this studio. Still listed on their Vancouver page; our records have him in a San Francisco managing-director role
Jana Foit	Operations Director; Higher Education Practice Leader
Adrian Watson	Design Director, Vancouver
Ryan Bragg	Practice Leader — Corporate and Commercial
Shauna Bryce	Practice Leader — Cultural and Civic
Jeff Doble	Transportation — principal level
Kerri Henderson	Advisory Services
Jason LeBlanc	Urban Design
Max Richter	Sports, Recreation and Entertainment
Rufina Wu	Interior Design Director
Kathy Wardle	Principal; Regional Director of Regenerative Design, Canada
Alex Minard	Principal; Technical Director, Vancouver and Calgary
Cillian Collins	Associate Principal — cillian.collins@perkinswill.com
Aaron Knorr	Associate Principal
Tarek Zeidan	Associate Principal — led Great Northern Way Office and Pavilion

NAME	ROLE
Mike Murray · Melissa Sachs	Listed in the studio; their page gives no discipline and we hold nothing further

This is all eighteen people their Vancouver page lists. Studio: **1075 West Georgia St, Suite 2200** · +1 604 684 5446. Stated strengths: higher education, cultural and civic, transportation, commercial.

Addresses follow **firstname.lastname@perkinswill.com**, confirmed for Newby, Foit, Watson, Bragg, Bryce, Wardle and Busby.

► SUSAN GUSHE IS NOW CHIEF OPERATIONS OFFICER

She ran the Vancouver studio for years, taking it over when Peter Busby moved to San Francisco. She is now **Chief Operations Officer of the firm** — a Vancouver-rooted person running global operations at a 2,600-person practice, and the strongest relationship fact on this page.

David Dove and **Jim Huffman** are long-standing Vancouver principals but do not appear on the current studio leadership page. Greet them by name rather than by title.

► JEFF DOBLE IS THE ONE TO FIND

He is the transportation name on the Vancouver studio page, and the firm is currently recruiting **two Regional Practice Leaders for Transit & Transportation Architecture** — Chicago and San Francisco. Vancouver already has the discipline; the firm is scaling it. That is a growing practice with its Canadian person sitting in this city. Ask him what he is chasing, not what his title is.

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PEOPLE

Who runs what

We hold **138 people** at Perkins&Will. These are the ones who decide things.

NAME	ROLE
Susan Gushe	Chief Operations Officer
Tyson Curcio	Chief Practice Officer
Gabrielle Bullock	Principal, Chief Diversity Officer
Jim Bynum	Healthcare Practice Leader 29 open roles
Lisa Pool	Director of Workplace Strategy 35 open roles
David Damon	Higher Education Practice Leader
Heidi Costello	Health Education Practice Leader
Michal Mrowiec	Transportation Practice Leader
Gilad Rosenzweig	Director of Research and Development
John Haymaker	Director of Research
Mary Dickinson · Richard Herring · Tom Reisenbichler	Regional Directors
Cecily Eckhardt	Principal & Managing Director, Ontario
Trevor Abramson	Managing Director, Southern California
Kay Kornovich	Managing Principal, San Diego — science & technology
Safdar Abidi	Principal, Higher Education, Toronto

NAME	ROLE
Kaz Bremner · Marc Haberli	Calgary studio co-leads

All carry firstname.lastname@perkinswill.com. The full 138 are in the BD platform.

THE WORK

What they are building

Canada, outside BC

- ◆ **University of Calgary — Interdisciplinary Science and Innovation Centre**, transforming the east campus gateway. Our own awards data shows they took the architectural services contract. Ask where it has got to.
- ◆ **Toronto Metropolitan University — Daphne Cockwell Health Sciences Complex**, a **28-storey** health education tower they hold up as their model for dense urban campus design.
- ◆ Their **Calgary studio** sits in the historic Glenbow building, 822 11th Ave SW, Beltline — public-facing, pitched on adaptive reuse.

Federal Canada — a channel worth asking about

They carry **Government of Canada contracts**, which is a route into public work that has nothing to do with the private developer market either of us usually talks about.

- ◆ **Public Services and Procurement Canada** — two professional-services contracts awarded 6 March 2025, **\$200,439** and **\$42,309**.
- ◆ **Parks Canada** — architectural services at **\$316,315** (January and March 2017) and a further **\$364,768** for engineering consultants in December 2017.
- ◆ **University of Calgary** — the architectural services contract for the Interdisciplinary Science and Innovation Centre, through Alberta Purchasing, 2019.

Worth asking how much of their Canadian book is federal now, and who they team with on it.

United States

- ♦ **University of Louisville — Health Sciences Center** with Champlin | EOP.
- ♦ **University of Houston — RAD Center**, 2026 AIA Design Excellence Award, Education Facilities.
- ♦ **LSU Health Shreveport — Emerging Viral Threats Lab**, 2026 Lab Design Excellence Award.
- ♦ **UVA Health** emergency department expansion, IIDA-recognised.
- ♦ A **mall-to-college-campus conversion** honoured by ULI Americas in July.

Strategy and international

- ♦ **A global retail practice built in January** — five principals at once, led by Matt Billerbeck in Seattle. CEO Phil Harrison: "*to build the most sought-after retail practice in the world.*"
- ♦ **Science and technology pivoting to applied science** under **Jeff Zynda** — robotics, energy storage, AI, quantum — across all studios.
- ♦ **Merged with A+I**, a New York studio, effective September 2025.
- ♦ A **science and technology museum in Suzhou, China; triple winner at the 2026 RIBA International Awards; London named Studio of the Year** at Clerkenwell; **two AIA National Awards** in June.

PROVENANCE

Where each thing came from

- ♦ **Our own project and billing records:** the seven billed jobs and their amounts, the \$430,000 of unstarted Harry Jerome contract, and that nothing has ever been billed under Perkins&Will's own account. Only one Perkins entity exists in our Deltek, so there is no chance of confusion with Perkins Eastman in these figures.
- ♦ **Published contract records:** the federal and University of Calgary awards, from Open Canada's contract search and Alberta Purchasing. Award values are as published.

- ◆ **Checked against perkinswill.com:** who is in the Vancouver studio and the discipline each sits under, the studio address and phone, and Derek Newby's RAIC elevation on 27 May 2026 with its exact citation. ⚠ The site publishes no individual titles — its per-person pages redirect to a general listing — so every title here comes from our own records, not from them.
- ◆ **Firm scale, ownership, growth rates and the 128 open roles:** a commercial business-intelligence provider, pulled today. Revenue and headcount are modelled figures — good for scale, not for quoting to the dollar. ⚠ The same source counts 28 studios where the firm's own release says 32; use 32.
- ◆ **Susan Gushe as COO:** carried by two independent sources of ours — a roster refresh today and our own firm research in June, which recorded the move to a global COO role. Their site does not publish it. Two sources agreeing is why it is stated plainly where Jeff Doble's title is not.
- ◆ **Contact roster:** 138 people matched against their mail domain at 85%+ confidence. ⚠ **The firmwide titles in section 06 are as that source has them and are not individually confirmed** — use them to know who to look up, not to quote. Where a title was actively contested it was dropped rather than guessed: Jeff Doble is given as transportation, not "Director of Transportation", because two of our own sources disagree and the firm confirms neither.
- ◆ **Sections 04 and 07:** Perkins&Will's own published news, December 2025 to September 2026. Their framing of themselves — the right register for an event, but not independent.
- ◆ ⚠ **Not verified:** the current status of the University of Calgary project. Ask, do not assert.
- ◆ 🚫 **Perkins Eastman is a different firm.** We hold both. Do not blend them.